

chips, packaging and electronics systems.

Some of the action points recommended by the council include creation of advanced R&D centres in nanoelectronics, such as Centres of Excellence in Nanoelectronics (CENs) at IIT-Bombay and IISc, and funding of industry and academia projects of national interest.

ISA renamed IESA

India Semiconductor Association (ISA)—the trade body which represents the Indian ESDM and semiconductor industry—will now represent a broader spectrum that will include not just semiconductor companies but also the larger ecosystem of companies and organisations involved in the design and manufacture of electronics products. In tandem with this, the organisation will now be known as the India Electronics and Semiconductor Association (IESA).

“The semiconductor industry cannot grow unless the larger electronics industry grows. While consumption of electronic products is growing explosively in India, according to the 6th ISA F&S Report on the ESDM industry, 66 per cent of these products are imported and this number is growing,” said Dr Satya Gupta, chairman of IESA.

EFY Expo 2013 concludes successfully

The EFY Expo 2013 kickstarted with chief guest Kapil Sibal, minister of communications and information technology, inaugurating the event at Pragati Maidan in New Delhi. Bringing the entire electronics industry under one roof, this electronics show covered an area of 8090 sq.m with more than 200 exhibitors showcasing their products. The presence of global players from electronics-dominant nations like China, Japan and Taiwan at Expo increased the business scope for players in the Indian electronics industry.

The Expo was held in partnership with the Department of Electronics & IT (DeITY), Ministry of Communi-



Solar park

cations & IT, Government of India. It also had the support of NSIC and the approval of ITPO. Buyer-seller meetings arranged by ELCINA brought together players to network and explore business opportunities during the Expo.

Amara Raja to invest Rs 4.4 billion in automotive segment

Amara Raja Batteries, a subsidiary of Hyderabad-based Amara Raja Group, plans to invest Rs 4.4 billion to augment production capacities of its valve-regulated lead-acid (VRLA) batteries and four-wheeler batteries over a period of 16-18 months.

This investment is in addition to the already approved capital investment of around Rs 3.04 billion to expand capacities in medium VRLA, automotive four-wheeler and automotive two-wheeler product lines.

Emmvee developing 20MW solar park in Andhra Pradesh

Having developed and installed several MW projects in Germany, Emmvee has entered the field of large-scale PV project development in India in addition to roof-top PV installation.

Emmvee is currently developing a 20MW solar park, which will be partially owned by third parties and by Emmvee with 10 MW as Emmvee Green Power Park. It will be responsible for the engineering, procurement, construction and operation and maintenance of the entire solar park. The solar park will be built at Hindupur in

Andhra Pradesh, approximately 100 km north of Bengaluru.

Dreamchip plans India's own processor-based tablet SoC

Dreamchip Electronics plans to launch SoCs for tablet computers. The SoCs will come in three different variants named Siddhi, Vani and Sandesh. Each of these has been specified and optimised for a distinct tablet application. Dreamchip will use a proprietary multi-core 32-bit RISC and DSP processor architecture and a unique optimised direct-connect architecture for powering these SoCs.

Intel to quit motherboard business

Intel, one of the world's biggest CPU and chipset manufacturers, has decided to stop making desktop motherboards by 2016. The company has announced that its upcoming Haswell motherboard will be the last Intel-branded motherboard.

This decision may come as a shock to the global industry but on the hindsight, Intel may be making a smart move. It comes as no surprise that sales of tablets and smartphones have surpassed the demand for desktops globally, and that is why Intel may be inclining towards the convergent form of devices.

However, the company has reiterated that it will continue manufacturing and providing chipsets and reference designs to its partners such as ASUSTek, Gigabyte and MSI.

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